STATUS REPORT

Comoros: status report

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GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · DIGITALISATION · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · DATA · GEOPOLITICS

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

Comorian digital policy still runs on a document drafted in 2018. Stratégie Comores Numérique 2028, adopted by the Council of Ministers in 2019, covers the digitalisation of public services with fourteen planned e-government platforms and names interoperability as a component, with no standalone data-exchange strategy behind it. Its six strategic axes and thirteen strategic orientations sit under the Plan Comores Émergent, costed at 52,995,160,485 KMF with national broadband coverage the largest line at 32,629,410,800 KMF, and it designed a three-body architecture: a Conseil National sur le Numérique chaired by the Secrétaire général du gouvernement, ANADEN to implement, and an Observatoire national du numérique to measure sector performance.

Artificial intelligence has no strategy of its own. In June 2024 ANADEN put artificial intelligence in the country at its earliest stirrings, with the measures and strategies to govern it still to be considered, after its delegation attended the Riyadh global AI governance assembly. The Council of Ministers on 11 March 2026 added the Ministry of the Interior to the committee assessing institutional, technical and regulatory readiness for artificial intelligence, with the evaluation due to conclude in June 2026. At AI Forward Comores in August 2026 the Minister of Posts, Telecommunications and Digital Affairs named structured data, talent and Comorian content as the foundations still to be built.

The governance it works through is weakening. Comoros scored 42.8 out of 100 for Overall Governance in the 2024 Ibrahim Index of African Governance, 40th of 54 African states and below the African average of 49.3, having fallen 4.7 points and twelve rank places from 28th over 2014-2023. It sits below the continental average on 50 of the index's 96 indicators, improving on 31 across the decade, declining on 38 and unchanged on nine, and its Public Administration sub-category scored 31.5 out of 100 in 2023, 47th of 54 and unmoved since 2014.

Delivery under the strategy is donor-shaped: the e-Msomo and e-Shiyo education platforms launched under it in June 2025 with UNICEF funding, and the country runs two donor-funded e-government tracks, the AfDB's PADEC and the EU and Expertise France e-Administration programme.

Legislation and regulation

Comoros put artificial intelligence into statute for the first time in Article 231 of the Code de l'information et de la communication, promulgated by Décret n°26-023/PR on 2 February 2026, which requires explicit labelling of content that is AI-generated or heavily modified by AI; the code devotes Articles 230 to 236 to the subject, banning AI-generated deepfakes and disinformation outright at Article 232 and making publishers and editors liable at

Article 233 for what they carry. The labelling duty is backed by graduated administrative sanctions of up to 1,000,000 KMF and by a national awareness campaign under the slogan « Si c'est de l'IA, ça doit se voir ». It is in force as Loi n°25-021/AU, which expressly abrogates the 2021 code it replaces.

Four months later Décret n°26-070/PR of 4 June 2026 set a legal regime for renewable self-production and mini-grids: a free prior declaration for Type A installations below 5kW, and a three-year authorisation from the regulator ARSEE, on a technical opinion from the grid manager SONELEC, for Type B mini-grids of 5 to 250kW and for larger Type C systems. It introduces net metering, exempts listed equipment from customs duty, and gives existing installations twenty-four months to register.

The stack underneath is thinner. The government's own Stratégie Comores Numérique 2028 found the legal framework centred on telecommunications, with a vacuum on digital transactions, electronic money, dematerialisation of administrative procedures, electronic signature, cybercrime and personal-data protection, and put 27,000,000 KMF behind closing it — the second-smallest line in the strategy. ANADEN set out in March 2021 a programme to consolidate the whole of it into a code numérique by 2024, with cybersecurity, personal-data and dematerialised-procurement texts drafted and an e-commerce law still to be written.

A personal-data statute, Loi n°14-029/AU, was adopted in plenary by the Assemblée de l'Union on 26 June 2014 and Loi n°23-016/AU of 27 July 2023 mandates computerised processing of civil-registry data, but the Code de procédure pénale of 22 December 2014 names no electronic form for a procès-verbal.

Data protection

Comoros has acquired a second data-protection enforcer before constituting its first. Articles 216 to 220 of the Code de l'information et de la communication give the press regulator CNPA authority to investigate and sanction personal-data breaches in the media sector, enforcing collection, consent and security duties — while the national data-protection authority provided for in law had not been constituted or made operational as of mid-2024. The general statute, Loi n°14-029/AU, deliberated and adopted in plenary by the Assemblée de l'Union on 26 June 2014, gives supervision to a Commission nationale de l'informatique et des libertés.

The statute requires processing to be declared to the commission and, for biometric, health and national-identification data, authorised by it. It imposes no data localisation requirement, conditioning cross-border transfers on the adequacy of the destination state's protection without requiring any category of data to be held inside the country.

Practice has run a decade behind the text. Comorian biometric records sat offshore with the outgoing contractor Semlex, a position the Minister of the Interior himself called abnormal, until Semlex handed the database back to the government on 24 March 2026. The national identity system offers individuals no means of viewing the data held on them, publishes no data-handling or data-sharing rules, and carries no legally binding redress mechanism. The Ibrahim Index's Digital Freedom measure — online censorship, government internet shutdowns and freedom of online expression — fell 8.1 points over 2014-2023 to 65.1 out of 100, 21st of 54 African states.

Regional collaboration

Membership has not translated into integration. Comoros's Regional Integration score in the Ibrahim Index fell 5.5 points over 2014-2023 to 39.0 out of 100, 34th of 54 African states, despite membership of COMESA, CEN-SAD and SADC.

Payments are where the joining-up is being attempted. The Banque Centrale des Comores signed the Pan-African Payment and Settlement System membership agreement in July 2024 and gathered commercial-bank and microfinance heads for a workshop that August, though the system's June 2026 coverage map still marks Comoros

as live soon rather than live. On the regulatory side, the press regulator CNPA and the ministry for gender, solidarity and information organised the international EMICn colloquium in Moroni for 5 and 6 May 2026 with RIARC, with algorithmic manipulation among its media-literacy themes and a Déclaration de Moroni as its intended outcome. Bahrain's e-government authority held its first knowledge-exchange session with the Comorian digital agency, on the governance and approval of government technology projects (2026).

Standards

Standard-setting in Comoros is, in practice, quality-of-service policing of the two mobile operators. ANRTIC presented its 2024 national mobile quality-of-service audit on 30 October 2024, measuring Comores Télécom and Telma Comores against 23 indicators over three months and testing conformity with their contractual and regulatory commitments. Its finding was coverage gaps requiring both operators to redouble their efforts, with director-general Saïd Bouhtane restating the authority's power to sanction and attributing the difficulty to the archipelago's relief, and the telecoms minister asking the regulator for a quarterly quality-of-service bulletin. A further control campaign presented in February 2026 again found both operators short on multiple indicators, with 4G coverage inside buildings and vehicles below standard.

Two other standards levers are moving. Technical management of the .km country-code top-level domain is passing from Comores Télécom to ANADEN under arrêté n°24-02, which requires an ICANN re-delegation step. And Décret n°26-070/PR requires technical professionals and installers working on renewable self-production and mini-grids to hold a certification issued by the Ministry and valid for three years.

Public debate and participation in policymaking

The Union Assembly took a piece of the government's own bill out of it. On 26 December 2025 deputies adopted the new code de l'information et de la communication by 31 votes of 33, amending 25 articles and deleting 18, and struck from the floor the government's proposed exception to journalistic source protection, « sauf décision judiciaire motivée », so that the article — renumbered from 169 to 153 — states without qualification that a journalist is not obliged to disclose sources.

The surrounding trend runs the other way. The Ibrahim Index's Media Freedom score fell 10.0 points to 58.1 out of 100 between 2014 and 2023, 19th of 54 African states, and Freedom of Expression and Belief fell 16.0 points to 44.6, 37th of 54. Comoros scored zero on the UN E-Participation Index in 2023. No access-to-information law had been adopted as at January 2026, the code de l'information et de la communication being a press law.

Institutions for the debate exist mainly on paper. Articles 58 to 66 of the code create SCEPAC, a holding company supervising and coordinating the public broadcasters, and outside government UONI, an association of Comorian diaspora scientists, held a webinar on artificial intelligence on 24 January 2026 whose conclusions called on public research and innovation institutions to lead in defining a clear national AI strategy.

Finance

Financial sustainability

Comoros's 2026 finance law gives the digital ministry its first capital line in three years, KMF 50m of state money, and nearly doubles the state transfer to the digital agency ANADEN to KMF 145m, against KMF 75m voted for 2025. The finance ministry's systems directorate, cut to nothing in the 2025 rectificative, returns at KMF 277.1m for 2026, KMF 70m of it state investment.

The externally built systems sit outside that vote. The 2025 law printed no donor capital line for the digital ministry, and the 2026 law's annexed external investment programme carries the digitalisation project PADEC on African Development Bank and Islamic Development Bank money, civil-registry modernisation on French money and statistics capacity on World Bank money. PADEC's appraisal puts the government's counterpart at UA 1.85m in kind against a total cost of UA 18.47m, and closes the project on 31 December 2028. The government data centres it finances are to be operated, maintained and expanded by a private operator under a public-private partnership (October 2024).

What is voted is not all spent: the telecommunications ministry executed KMF 140m of a KMF 613m transfer provision in 2024.

Own-source financing reaches the regulator rather than programmes. The 2023 electronic communications amendment funds ANRTIC from a regulation tax of 2%, 1% or 0.5% of operators' prior-year turnover by licence class, plus 10% of licence fees and 40% of fines, in force since February 2024.

MoUs and other agreements

AXIAN and Mastercard agreed a partnership in November 2025 to issue virtual and physical cards through AXIAN's Mixx and MVola wallets, naming Comoros among five African markets covered.

New investments

The African Development Bank and the Multilateral Cooperation Center for Development Finance have said they are ready to fund feasibility studies for Comoros's national digital-connectivity project, a data centre with inter-island links to be taken forward through ANADEN (August 2026). The largest money on the books is much older: China Eximbank signed a CNY 567 million concessional loan with Comores Télécom on 11 December 2018 for the Telecommunications Network Modernization Project, on a thirty-year maturity with five years' grace at 1% interest, financing an USD 81 million Huawei contract to modernise the state operator and extend the Huri network nationwide, still the largest single digital commitment the country has. Yas Comores, AXIAN Telecom's Comorian subsidiary, secured a €25 million loan from the International Finance Corporation in June 2025 for 5G, fibre-to-the-home and fibre-to-the-office rollout, and AXIAN Telecom pledged USD 82 million in 2025 under the ITU's Partner2Connect coalition to expand 4G across Madagascar, Comoros and Tanzania, a pledge whose Comorian share is not broken out. Beyond the networks, the PADEC digitalisation programme carries technical assistance from the African Development Bank running from 2024 to 2028 alongside about USD 7 million committed by the Islamic Development Bank from 2025, and the World Bank put US$30 million into emergency cash transfers and a shock-responsive safety net in February 2023. Comoros takes USD 164.1 of official development assistance per head, the third highest in Africa (2023).

Five digital-sector commitments reach Comoros, four country-level and the fifth a three-country operator pledge, spanning the 2018 Chinese loan to a pledge running to 2030 and worth over USD 200 million between them. China Eximbank is the largest financier by far, more than three times the next; the International Finance Corporation, the Islamic Development Bank and the African Development Bank hold the rest, none holding more than one commitment. Connectivity absorbs almost all of it, leaving single-digit millions each for government digital services and for policy support. Comoros is named in none of the large East African regional digital programmes recorded alongside it, the World Bank's Eastern Africa Regional Digital Integration Project among them.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

Comoros's telecoms regulator found both mobile operators deficient on multiple quality indicators when it presented a two-month, 22-indicator control campaign on 26 February 2026, with 4G coverage inside buildings and vehicles below standard, and the telecoms minister warned that there would be no further leniency and floated calling in a third operator before the 2027 Games. It followed the regulator's 2024 national mobile quality audit, presented in October 2024, which had already flagged coverage gaps.

Both operators now run 5G. Yas Comores launched in Moroni on 20 May 2025 using Huawei equipment, and the incumbent Comores Télécom followed on 2 June 2025 with a fixed-wireless service inaugurated by the President for the fiftieth independence anniversary. Yas's 5G and fibre rollout is backed by a loan from the International Finance Corporation approved in June 2025.

International capacity rests on three submarine cables run through the state company Comores Câbles — EASSy, FLY-LION3 and 2Africa, alongside the 260km Avassa system delivered in November 2016, which links Grande Comore and Anjouan to Mayotte. The Nafassi fibre-to-the-home network, built by Huawei for Comores Télécom under a Chinese concessional loan to modernise the state operator, was launched in March 2022 and carries household internet, television and fixed telephony over that submarine capacity.

Take-up lags the equipment. Internet use stood at 32.5% of individuals in 2024, against 35.67% in 2023, and the Ibrahim Index scores internet and computer access at 26.4 out of 100 in 2023, 35th of 54 African states against 69.2 for mobile communications, Comoros's third most improved indicator of 96. Around 21% of primary schools had internet access in 2021, with rural schools furthest behind.

ANADEN became manager of the .km country-code domain in May 2025, taking the national registry out of the incumbent's hands, on an arrêté whose transfer still requires an ICANN re-delegation. A month later the regulator banned the installation, testing and use of Starlink on 12 June 2025 pending a licence, acting on a ministerial circular and announcing field inspections to identify users.

Data Storage

Comoros opened a national data centre for the public administration on 19 May 2025, a Tier III facility rated at 44.4 terabits and co-managed by ANADEN with Comores Câble. The agency states that it will support the national DNS, digital identity and the state's e-service portals. A further, operator-neutral data centre is under construction.

Citizen biometric records came home in 2026. They had been held in Belgium under the outgoing document contractor, an arrangement the interior minister himself called abnormal; the database was handed back to the government on 24 March 2026, and the incoming contractor is to domicile the data in Comoros.

That repatriation was a matter of contract rather than of law: Comorian law imposes no data localisation requirement, conditioning cross-border transfers on adequacy and safeguards without requiring any category of data to be held in the country.

Energy

Anjouan's electricity access rate of 49% is barely half Ngazidja's 95%, with Mohéli at 87%, on the government's own National Energy Compact (2025) — an island divide much wider than the 12.2-point urban-rural gap behind the national figure of 89.8% access in 2023.

Generation is 91% diesel (2025), and supply is unreliable, with frequent prolonged outages, regular load shedding and high transmission losses on an ageing and poorly interconnected grid, rural areas worst affected. Fuel logistics are the sharp end of that: Mohéli was rationing electricity again in early August 2026 after diesel deliveries to the SONELEC thermal plant fell far below its daily requirement, the island depending on maritime resupply without a fuel depot sized to its needs. Power is also expensive, at about US$0.44 per kilowatt-hour in 2024. Around 48% of primary schools had electricity in 2021.

The 2018 Power Sector Master Plan's target of lifting renewables from 16% to 30% of generation by 2033 has stalled amid unclear institutional arrangements, and no binding mini-grid framework existed as at 2025. Décret n°26-070/PR of 4 June 2026 set a legal regime for renewable self-production and mini-grids. The compact makes off-grid and mini-grid deployment the priority route to access on Anjouan and Mohéli, the UNDP/GEF Africa Minigrids Programme is preparing three mini-grid pilots across Grande Comore, Mohéli and Anjouan, and a UAE-funded solar plant with battery storage was commissioned as a microgrid on Grande Comore in 2026.

The money is external. The World Bank set out about US$5m of additional financing for the Comoros Solar Energy Access Project in a March 2025 project paper and has a further operation for SONELEC network strengthening and access expansion in preparation as at April 2026. The compact commits Comoros to universal access by 2030 and plans digital components alongside it — smart meters, mobile payment and an ERP system for SONELEC. Against that, access to energy is one of Comoros's better Ibrahim Index measures, up 10.6 points over 2014-2023 to 48.5, 19th of 54.

Technical Capacity

Comoros's national digital agency, the body that would have to hold the expertise, said in June 2024 that attending the Riyadh AI governance assembly would help it grasp artificial intelligence and advise government on it.

The administration around it is not stronger. Effective Administration fell 2.6 points over 2014-2023 to 36.4 out of 100, 43rd of 54 African states, and the Public Administration sub-category it sits in scored 31.5, 47th of 54. Cybersecurity has at least a named home for the skill: ANADEN's Direction Nationale de Cyber Sécurité is organised into a security-technologies department and a security-audit department.

Specialist capacity arrives with the projects that need it. The AfDB's €9.51 million approved in October 2024 pays for a new government data centre to be run by a private operator under a public-private partnership, and SONELEC, ministry and regulator staff took a five-day mini-grid pricing and regulation course in June 2026 run by the African Forum for Utility Regulators.

Cybersecurity

Comoros sits in the Evolving tier, the fourth of five, of the ITU's Global Cybersecurity Index 2024. The founding statute is Loi n°21-012/AU on cybersecurity and the fight against cybercrime, adopted on 25 June 2021 and promulgated by Décret n°22-003/PR on 18 January 2022.

The law defines cybercrime terminology, asserts Comorian jurisdiction over offences with any link to the national territory and criminalises illegal access, breaches of data and system integrity and computer fraud, with penalties running from one year and KMF 500,000 to twenty years and KMF 50,000,000 where critical infrastructure is touched. ANADEN's cybersecurity directorate is the competent authority designated under Article 6.

Much of the criminal law sits outside that statute. The Penal Code of 29 December 2020 carries cybercrime offences at articles 449 to 505, covering ICT-specific offences, online intellectual-property infringement, illicit conduct on electronic communications networks and the liability of online service providers, and reaching cybercafés, minors' access and false information; the reform was piloted by the justice ministry with the telecoms ministry, the regulator ANRTIC, ACTIC, the interior ministry and the World Bank.

Both instruments answer a gap the state had set out itself: the Stratégie Comores Numérique 2028 found in December 2018 that the digital legal framework was centred on telecommunications and left a vacuum on digital transactions, electronic money, dematerialisation of administrative procedures, electronic signature, cybercrime and personal-data protection, and ANADEN set out in March 2021 a programme to consolidate the new laws into a code numérique.

DPI

Data Exchange

A third donor programme went to market for a Comorian government interoperability platform in 2026, when the Islamic Development Bank issued procurement notices covering an interoperability and data exchange platform for its public administration modernisation project. It follows the African Development Bank's PADEC, launched with a steering committee and an adopted work plan on 27-28 March 2025, and the EU and Expertise France e-Administration programme, launched in October 2025 to build a single-window service portal and an interoperability layer. None has produced a working platform: as at October 2024 an interoperability and data-exchange platform was still to be built under the AfDB grant, and the national identity system is not interoperable with other government systems.

The exchange that does happen is bilateral and sectoral. A memorandum of understanding between the Ministry of Health and ANACM, the national meteorological agency, underpins the flow of climate data into the health information system (July 2026). An AFD-financed financial governance project, PAGF-SI, has been improving the interfacing between the tax system SIGIT, the SYDONIA customs system and other Ministry of Finance systems since 2022, though the World Bank's 2023 public expenditure review still recommends introducing automated exchange of taxpayer information between the tax administration and other government bodies. Outside finance and health, health records, learner records, job seeker registries, court records, driver licensing, voter registration, social protection and business registration are integrated into no cross-government system (2025).

Policy names the goal without a document behind it: the Comores Numérique 2028 strategy carries interoperability as a component but there is no standalone data exchange strategy. The one interoperable national rail actually in service is financial — the payment switch that went live in August 2025, connecting banks, microfinance institutions and mobile money operators.

Digital Identity and CRVS

Semlex handed the Comorian biometric database back to the government on 24 March 2026, ending the Belgian contractor's holding of citizens' biometric data offshore — a position the Minister of the Interior himself called abnormal. GenKey of the Netherlands has taken over production of the biometric passport and national identity card, with the data to be domiciled in Comoros, announced at the end of December 2025 for effect from April. The changeover cost citizens three weeks of service, with the Ministry of the Interior suspending production of biometric documents from 2 or 6 March, depending on the island, to 26 March 2026, and card production, until now concentrated in Moroni, is to begin on Ndzuani (February 2026).

The founding statute is younger in law than in date. Loi n°14-023/AU of 24 June 2014 instituting the digital biometric identity card sat unpromulgated for a decade, taking effect only through Décret n°14-137/PR of 28 August 2024. Holding a card has been compulsory for every Comorian from the age of 18 since 1987, and from 12 August 2025 carrying and presenting it at identity checks became obligatory. It is not free: the 1987 law imposes a stamp duty, and holders paid 4,000 rising to 5,000 Comorian francs for the biometric card in January 2018.

What the system does not do is authenticate. It provides no digital authentication function, and no government portal authenticates users against it; it also offers individuals no means of viewing the data held on them, publishes no data-handling or data-sharing rules, and carries no legally binding redress mechanism (2024).

Civil registration remains largely manual, with preparatory studies for nationwide digitisation under the France-funded, UNICEF-supported AMECC programme validated on 25 March 2026, establishing a Personal Identification Number as the cornerstone of identity alongside a technical, legal and institutional framework and interoperability with other state systems. Against that ambition, the 2026 appropriation gives the directorate responsible for civil status and the criminal record KMF 4,000,000.

Digital Payments and Fintech

The Banque Centrale des Comores launched four payment systems — KomorPay/ATS, Mali Ya Wakazi, Komor Switch and the public securities market at a ceremony on 4 May 2026, and its own account of the launch sets Komor Switch out in three phases: card withdrawal at any ATM in the country, then instant bank-to-mobile-money transfer, then card and phone payment at any merchant.

That stack sits on an earlier one. PayLogic announced on 16 February 2025 that it would build Comoros's national interoperable payment switch and the switch went live in August 2025, interconnecting banks, microfinance institutions and mobile-money operators on a single rail; a World Bank implementation status report in March 2025 had put its completion at end-May 2025, with a pilot with three institutions still to run and alias processing, instant payments and bill payments unresolved. The central bank's electronic-money regulation n°01/2017 is published.

Around the rails, private money is moving faster than the state's own payments. The central bank granted AXIAN a Decentralised digital Financial Institution licence, announced on 24 February 2026, a separately regulated entity offering mobile-delivered nano- and micro-credit alongside MVola, and KomoraLink, a business-to-business and e-commerce platform built with technology partner Kartapay and backed by the chamber of commerce, launched on 24 April 2026. Person-to-government payment has not followed: official procedural guidance still settles property tax by cheque or cash at the Trésorerie Générale (2026). Cross-border, the June 2026 PAPSS coverage map still marks Comoros as live soon rather than live, two years after the central bank signed the PAPSS membership agreement in July 2024.

The banking layer underneath all of this is thin. Access to Banking Services is Comoros's fifth worst indicator in the Ibrahim Index at 4.5 out of 100 in 2023, 46th of 54 African states and up just 1.4 points across 2014-2023, and the central bank coordinates the Stratégie Nationale d'Inclusion Financière 2025-2030 in response.

Registries

Comoros's largest working register is not the civil one: the World Bank-supported Registre social unique had 62,000 households registered as at July 2026. Civil registration itself remains largely manual, with a 2022 assessment having found high costs, frequent errors and document-fraud risk in it, and the Ibrahim Index's Civil Registration score has not moved from 50.0 out of 100 across 2014-2023, 31st of 54. The most recent measurement of birth

registration completeness is 87.3%, from the 2012 Demographic and Health Survey. The agency meant to run a digitised registry does not yet exist: the implementing decree for the Agence nationale de l'état civil, provided for by the law of 27 July 2023, was in island consultations in late 2025.

Elsewhere the pattern is a mandate without a build. Décret n°23-045/PR of 2 May 2023 created the Direction Nationale des Affaires Foncières et Domaniales and assigned it title registration, cadastre, the digitisation and electronic archiving of land documents and a national property database, yet land records are still held on paper at the Service des Domaines (2026), and most landowners have not registered their property, in a country with almost no land registry. The household and business addressing and directory process launched on 19 December 2022 set itself an end-2023 completion target.

The older instruments are fiscal and electoral. The unique taxpayer file dates from the Code général des impôts promulgated on 23 July 2011; the electoral register is computerised and centralised under the Centre National de Traitement des Données Electorales and carried 338,940 electors for the January 2024 presidential election. For business, ANPI runs a public online directory filterable by island, sector, year of registration and RCCM number.

The computerised national population register, the land and cadastre registry under DNAFD and the electoral register are three separate builds standing on three separate legal instruments, not one converging system.

Sectoral management information systems

Health is the one sector with a national management information system that works. DHIS2 has been the national health management information system since 2022, almost 99% of public health facilities use it for routine reporting, and a World Bank-funded electronic logistics project launched in 2024 put an Android Real-Time Stock tool into 58 of the country's 74 facilities, 78%, within three months of going live (November 2025). A formal memorandum with the meteorological agency ANACM brings climate data into the same system (July 2026), and the country used ODK digital capture feeding real-time dashboards for the first time in a national campaign, the October 2025 measles-rubella drive targeting 101,000 children. Social protection gained its first digital claims and enrolment layer when the openIMIS-based Assurance Maladie Généralisée pilot began enrolling beneficiaries in Mohéli in December 2025.

Education got its first individual-level systems when the Ministry of Education and ANADEN launched e-Msomo for online grade entry, automated report cards and unique student identifiers, and e-Shiyo, a digital textbook library, on 5 June 2025.

Public financial management has the most systems and the least to show for them. PAGF-SI has been improving the interfacing between SIGIT, SYDONIA and other Ministry of Finance systems, and the Direction Générale des Impôts held a validation workshop from 15 to 17 April 2026 on the legal corpus for téléprocédures fiscales — online filing, electronic payment and paperless registration. The 2026 finance act imposes phased télédéclaration and télépaiement obligations on large and medium taxpayers whose implementation dates were left to regulation; priority 5 of the FY2025 framing letter commits the state to consolidating the information systems used in financial management; and the IMF's 2025 Article IV consultation, concluded by its Board on 11 February 2026, still lists tax and customs administration reform among programme priorities. The outcomes are among the country's worst: Tax & Revenue Mobilisation stands at 15.2 out of 100, 51st of 54, and Budgetary & Financial Management at 26.4, 50th, both down over 2014-2023.

Justice has no system to speak of: the Code of Criminal Procedure of 22 December 2014 names no electronic form for a procès-verbal.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

Comoros's national online scholarship portal has not shipped: ANADEN's own delivery log still marks e-Bourse « En cours » after a technical meeting in June 2024 (2025). The country ranked 180th on the UN E-Government Development Index in 2024, with a score of about 0.25.

Three donor programmes are building the e-government layer, separately. The African Development Bank's PADEC was officially launched on 27-28 March 2025 on financing agreements signed during 2024, its 2025 annual work programme and budget validated that same month. The EU and Expertise France launched an e-Administration programme in October 2025 to build a single-window portal and an interoperability layer, a second donor-funded track. The Islamic Development Bank then issued 2026 procurement notices covering an interoperability and data exchange platform for public administration modernisation. All three postdate the Comores Numérique 2028 strategy's planned e-government platforms.

The services that exist are informational or partial. ANPI's public online business directory is the operative business-register interface. The tax administration is moving to téléprocédures under the 2026 finance act, with the implementing legal corpus validated at an April 2026 workshop before progressive activation. Paying the state is still physical, with property tax settled by cheque or cash at the Trésorerie Générale (2026). And nothing authenticates: the national ID system provides no digital authentication function and no government portal authenticates users against it. The finance ministry's FY2025 framing letter instructed every ministry to digitalise budget management and extend dematerialisation — a cross-government instruction issued through budget preparation rather than funded as a line in the ICT vote. One measure has moved: Business & Competition Regulations rose 10.9 points over 2014-2023 to 43.4 out of 100, 39th of 54 and one of the country's ten most improved indicators.

Digitalisation

Digitalisation of sub-national government

National identity card production has been concentrated in Moroni, and Ndzuani is to produce its own cards from April 2026 under the new supplier.

The other decentralisation under way is in civil status. A preliminary study for digitising the civil registry was launched on Mohéli in October 2025 under the AMECC decentralisation project, and a validation workshop for the preparatory studies was held in Moroni on 25 March 2026. The body meant to run the digitised registry does not yet exist: the implementing decree for a national civil-status agency was at the stage of island consultations in late 2025.

Sub-national digital capability otherwise depends on national programmes reaching the islands. Government data exchange is being built at national level, and the addressing and directory programme intended to give every household and business across the three islands a street address and a directory entry was launched in December 2022 with the Ministry of Land Use and Urban Planning.

Rural digital data capture

The agriculture ministry contracted the supply of IT equipment to the Centres Ruraux de Développement Économique, the decentralised agricultural extension centres, at KMF 33,840,000 in March 2026, the only named, priced and dated IT purchase by a Comorian ministry on the published contract record.

The digital capture that does exist outside the capital belongs almost entirely to health. Routine health-service reporting runs through DHIS2 at close to every public health facility, and an Android stock-management tool from an electronic logistics project launched in 2024 had reached most of the country's facilities by November 2025. The October 2025 measles-rubella vaccination drive was the first national health campaign to collect its data digitally, on

ODK, feeding real-time dashboards, and a pilot of the openIMIS-based Assurance Maladie Généralisée platform began enrolling beneficiaries and processing claims on Mohéli from December 2025, the country's first digital claims and enrolment system.

Elsewhere the point of service is still paper. Civil registration remains a largely manual system, its digitisation still at the study stage in March 2026. A school-management platform, e-Msomo, is in pilot at some public schools, with online grade entry and automatic report cards.

Rural governance measures are weakening: the Ibrahim Index's Rural Economy sub-category fell 15.9 points over 2014-2023 to 39.0 out of 100, 39th of 54, with Rural Representation & Participation down 48.6 points. One rural-facing digital service of consequence has been built: DIMAKOM, an agricultural marketplace and information platform for Comorian farmers, launched in March 2022, and it runs standalone, outside any government registry exchange.

Technology

AI

Comoros's first binding rules on artificial intelligence came through media law: the information and communication code promulgated on 2 February 2026 carries a whole chapter on AI, requiring explicit labelling of AI-generated or heavily modified content, banning deepfakes and disinformation outright, making publishers liable for what they carry, and creating a standing technology-and-ethics monitoring cell inside the press and audiovisual regulator, backed by graduated sanctions and an awareness campaign. Nothing yet reaches development, deployment or data use: ANADEN, the national digital agency, put AI in the country at its earliest stirrings (June 2024).

Applied work sits in health. DHIS2 Climate and Health predictive modelling is being piloted for malaria early warning in Ngazidja, on World Bank funding through the COMPASS project to June 2026 (July 2026), and researchers built a machine-learning malaria forecasting model on the same data (May 2026). The rest is demonstration: two locally built early-warning models pairing satellite imagery with trained AI agents were presented in Moroni on 19 August 2026, one on Karthala's seismovolcanic behaviour, one on the spread of juvenile delinquency.

Convening has run ahead of capability: a first national AI forum on 31 March 2026 and AI Forward Comores in Moroni on 25 August 2026, run by private consultancies with the ministry and both operators; skills work stays private and small, around 40 secondary-school pupils trained by a foundation in April 2025. A diaspora scientists' webinar in January 2026 called on public research institutions to define a national AI strategy, and the shikomori speech synthesis effort is held back by GPU costs, scarce paired text and audio, and too few translators (August 2026).

Artificial intelligence reached Comoros from unconnected directions between January and August 2026 — a webinar, a labelling rule, a language model, an Olympiad delegation, two research demonstrators and a health pilot — and only the health pilot has a named funder, a named end date and a data-sharing instrument behind it.

ICT Industry

Both of Comoros's operators have run 5G since mid-2025, Yas Comores from 20 May on Huawei equipment and the state incumbent Comores Télécom from 2 June over WTTX fixed wireless, and AXIAN's group plan confirms 5G and fibre live in Moroni (February 2026). The incumbent reported revenue of roughly KMF 17bn for 2024, presented alongside its own 5G and WTTx plans.

Around the two operators the industry is thin and mostly service-led. KomoraLink, a private business-to-business and e-commerce platform backed by the chamber of commerce, launched on 24 April 2026; DIMAKOM, an agricultural marketplace and information platform, has run as a standalone service since March 2022; and a locally developed enterprise resource planning product was presented at the country's first AI forum (March 2026). Firms of this size are visible to the state mainly as event partners: ANPI took gold partnership of the 2026 AI Forward edition. Company registration and competition rules were among the country's ten most improved governance indicators over the decade to 2023, while nothing on the digital economy is published as open data (2024), so the sector's own size and growth cannot be tracked from public statistics.

Innovation ecosystem

The Technopôle numérique entered its pilot phase on 29 January 2026, presented by the government as a step towards Comorian digital sovereignty; the project, planned for 2025 to 2028 with World Bank support, trained young people through a partnership with Huawei (January 2026). It lands on a small existing base: the incubators Innov'Lab and OUSSAID took part in a European soft-landing programme for African incubators in June 2024, and Innov'Lab, set up in 2017 by the union of chambers of commerce, has incubated dozens of enterprises and trained several hundred people (2023).

What follows incubation is harder to see. Recorded startup activity is minimal and no venture capital investment is visible (2024), and Comoros is absent from the 133 economies ranked in the 2024 WIPO Global Innovation Index, having last carried a score in the 2020 edition. The most substantial recent piece of applied invention came from a student: a text-to-speech model for shikomori was launched on 28 July 2026 by a Comorian master's student.

Capacity

Literacy

Media and information literacy became a piece of foreign policy in May 2026, when the press and audiovisual regulator CNPA and the Ministry of the Promotion of Gender, Solidarity and Information convened the EMICn colloquium in Moroni for some 150 participants from around twenty African delegations, with algorithmic manipulation on the agenda and a Déclaration de Moroni its intended outcome (May 2026).

The underlying education picture is one of access improving faster than what is taught. Comoros scored 48.9 out of 100 on education in the Ibrahim Index, 33rd of 54 countries and up 0.9 points across 2014–2023, with enrolment at 49.1 and 17th on the continent after a 2.6-point rise, while education quality fell 2.2 points to 36.8 (2023). More children in school, on a base that is getting no better.

The classrooms behind those numbers are thinly equipped. Electricity and internet access in primary schools remain limited, with rural schools worst served (2021), which sets the ceiling on anything delivered through a screen. The state's own digital push into schools is recent and narrow: e-Msomo, for grade entry, automated report cards and unique student identifiers, and e-Shiyo, a digital textbook library for pre-primary and primary pupils, were launched by the Ministry of Education with the digital agency ANADEN in June 2025.

Literacy about machines is being built by whoever will pay for it. The CNPA pairs its AI content-labelling rule with a public awareness campaign under the slogan "Si c'est de l'IA, ça doit se voir" (February 2026), and a private foundation, Hazi Haki, ran a second cohort of AI training for Comorian secondary-school pupils in April 2025. Neither is a national curriculum.

Training and skills

Comoros entered the International Olympiad in Artificial Intelligence for the first time in August 2026, sending two secondary-school students, chosen from four shortlisted, to Astana under the Olympiad's GAITE programme for emerging nations, jointly entered by ANADEN, its ministry and ACTIC's academy.

Skills are instead assembled event by event, mostly by external programmes with their own reasons for being there. The African Forum for Utility Regulators ran a five-day course on mini-grid pricing and regulation in June 2026 for more than 23 staff from the utility SONELEC, the energy ministry and the regulator, under UNDP and GEF's Africa Minigrids Program. The statistics institute INSEED trained staff in GIS cartography in April 2026 under STATCAP-KM, building the mapping base for the next census, and officials also took advanced GIS training from the Regional Centre for Mapping of Resources for Development that month. Civil registration is at the same stage: civil-status agents joined island consultation workshops on the draft implementing decree for the new registration agency (late 2025).

Domestic provision is narrow. Tertiary technology teaching runs through the University of Comoros' Institut Universitaire de Technologie, and the state's flagship is a hub rather than a faculty: the Technopôle numérique entered its pilot phase on 29 January 2026, with a youth training target attached to it that has yet to be met.

Certification is beginning to bite where the money is. Décret n°26-070/PR requires technical professionals and installers working on renewable self-production and mini-grids to hold a ministry-issued certification valid for three years. On the demand side, AI Forward Comores opened at the Palais du peuple in Moroni on 25 August 2026, run by two private consultancies with the digital ministry and the operators Yas and Comores Telecom, where the minister named structured data, talent and Comorian content as the foundations the country has to build.

Research institutions

The clearest recent AI research out of a Comorian public institution is at demonstration stage. A seismologist at the Centre National de Documentation et de Recherche Scientifique presented two locally built AI early-warning models at the American Corner in Moroni on 19 August 2026, both combining satellite imagery with trained AI agents — one aimed at detecting changes in Karthala's seismovolcanic behaviour, the other at limiting the spread of juvenile delinquency, the volcano tool simulated with real data to show its operational use (August 2026).

Where research has connected to a working data source it has gone further. Comorian researchers built an AI-driven predictive-epidemiology model for malaria on routine DHIS2 case data, testing machine-learning and deep-learning approaches to forecast incidence, and had it accepted as a digital poster at the 2026 DHIS2 Annual Conference (May 2026).

Language technology is the other active strand, and it is being done by a student. Komori Tts, a speech-synthesis model for shikomori, was launched on 28 July 2026 by a Comorian master's student, and its developer names the cost of GPU compute, the volume of text and audio data needed and a shortage of translators for shindzuani, shimwali and shimaore as its obstacles (August 2026) — three constraints a funded research programme exists to remove.

Diaspora scientists are the ones asking for that programme. At a UONI webinar on artificial intelligence in Comoros on 24 January 2026, the conclusions called on public research and innovation institutions to lead in defining a clear national AI strategy.

Inclusion

Access to services

Comoros scores 30.5 out of 100 for equal access to public services in the Ibrahim Index, 37th of 54 African states and 3.5 points down on 2014, while access to public services for women rose 2.7 points over the same decade to 37.1 (2023). Who can reach a state service at all is therefore the constraint on any digital channel built to deliver one, and it has been tightening rather than easing.

The payments machinery has moved quickly against that background. A national payment switch went live in August 2025, interconnecting banks, microfinance institutions and mobile-money operators on a single rail, and a central-bank payment stack of KomorPay, Komor Switch and Mali Ya Wakazi was inaugurated at a presidential launch in May 2026. The Banque Centrale des Comores coordinates a national financial inclusion strategy for 2025-2030, one of whose four axes is dedicated to financial education and consumer protection, and it licensed AXIAN as a regulated digital lender in February 2026. The banking layer underneath is thin: access to banking services is among Comoros's worst-scoring indicators in the same index (2023).

Access to the state's own services still turns on documents. The national identity card is not free at first issuance, and production of biometric documents stopped for three weeks in March 2026 while the document contractor changed over. Most landowners have not registered their property, a programme to register titles having gone unimplemented (2020). Where a service has been digitised the delivery can stall: the national scholarship portal e-Bourse is still marked in progress in ANADEN's own delivery log after a technical meeting in June 2024 (2025).

Money does reach people digitally where a register exists to find them. Vulnerable households have received socio-economic recovery grants and cash transfers through banks, microfinance institutions or mobile money under the World Bank-supported social safety net project (2023), and the Registre social unique had tens of thousands of households enrolled by July 2026.

Digital divides

The deepest split in Comoros runs between its own islands: electricity access on Anjouan, at 49%, is roughly half Ngazidja's 95% and well behind Mohéli's 87% (2025). The mobile networks are uneven too — the regulator's 2024 quality-of-service audit found coverage gaps and told both operators to redouble their efforts, ANRTIC's director-general restating the authority's power to sanction and putting the difficulty down to the archipelago's relief.

Within each island rural areas are worst served, and schools show it: most Comorian primary schools had no internet connection in 2021, and around half no electricity, rural schools furthest behind. It is not only a matter of wires — rural representation and participation is among the most sharply deteriorated of Comoros's ninety-six measures in the Ibrahim Index over the decade to 2023, so the rural population has been losing voice in the arrangements that decide where investment goes.

Mobile coverage, at 77.6%, runs far ahead of internet penetration at 35.7% (early 2025), which means the constraint on a digital public service is rarely the handset and usually the connection behind it. Language is a further filter, and one nobody is funding: the first speech synthesis for shikomori is held back by the cost of GPU compute, the volume of text and audio data needed, and a shortage of translators for shindzuani, shimwali and shimaore (August 2026).

Data

National statistics

Comoros launched its fifth general population and housing census on 5 June 2026, with a pilot enumeration set for September 2026 and the main count for September 2027, and INSEED trained staff in GIS cartography in April 2026 under the STATCAP-KM programme with ESRI to build the geospatial base for enumeration mapping.

The census is the strong end of a thin programme. The World Bank's Statistical Performance Indicators record a population census within the last ten years and an agricultural census within the last twenty, but no business census in twenty years (2023), and three or more household surveys, two health surveys and two labour force surveys in the past decade against no agricultural and no business survey (2023). The weakness sits underneath the outputs rather than in them: the same assessment scores products at 70-89% and data use at 50-69% but data infrastructure at only 20-49%, the weakest assessed pillar, and returns no score at all for data services or data sources (2023).

The Ibrahim Index makes the point from the other side. Capacity of the Statistical System is Comoros's sixth most improved indicator, up 13.7 points over 2014-2023 to 29.6 out of 100, and still 49th of 54 African states. Eighteen of the index's 96 indicators carry no Comorian data at all (2023), among them every public-perception measure as well as education completion, human resources in education, rural market access and enforcement of environmental policies.

Filling those gaps is largely donor work. INSEED was a partner, alongside ANADEN, the health ministry, Customs and the planning commission, in a 2022-2023 UN Joint SDG Fund programme to establish systematic data management and a national digital statistics repository; observation capacity is arriving the same way, with the IAWASuR water programme to install 49 automatic weather stations (August 2025). The statute behind all of it, Loi n°11-003/AU of 26 March 2011, creates a Conseil National de la Statistique, makes INSEED the lead public statistics institute, and sets statistical secrecy, response obligations and penalty bands for non-response or falsified returns.

Open data

The finance ministry publishes a beneficial-ownership list of public contracts (November 2025), naming for each award the contract title, the beneficial owners, the project or institution and the amount. Its formatting undoes much of that: the single amount column mixes currencies, marked only inline row by row, most rows in Comorian francs and a handful in euros, so the table cannot be totalled as it stands.

Budget reporting has the same shape. The Compte administratif for 2024 is dated 14 March 2025, reporting execution at ministry grain roughly three months after year-end, but it is organised by economic nature first, with a separate per-ministry table under each nature and no consolidated per-ministry outturn column, so a ministry's total execution can be had only by summing across tables, and appropriation, revision and execution appear together nowhere but a state-aggregate table. The FY2026 framing letter carries both the economic and administrative budget nomenclatures across its 35 pages where the seven-page FY2025 letter carried neither, and is also where provisional half-year 2025 execution figures appear (June 2025).

None of it rests on a right. No access-to-information law has been adopted, the code de l'information et de la communication being a press law (January 2026). The Ibrahim Index puts Comoros 53rd of 54 for Disclosure of Public Records at 1.4 out of 100, down 18.3 points over 2014-2023, and 52nd for Accessibility of Public Records at 3.1 (2023).

Published statistics thin sharply by category. The 2024 Open Data Inventory's best Comorian scores are the built environment at 7.5 out of ten, trade and poverty at 7 and balance of payments at 6.5, with national accounts, prices, labour and reproductive health at 6; among categories with anything published, education facilities rate 2, health

facilities 3 and government finance 4. Energy, pollution, natural resources, crime, food security, gender and health outcomes score zero, as does the digital economy category covering ICT and telecommunications statistics — nothing there meets ODIN's criteria (2024).

Use of satellite data

Comoros sourced geospatial capacity from outside twice in April 2026: officials took advanced GIS training delivered by the Regional Centre for Mapping of Resources for Development, a regional African body, and INSEED separately trained staff in GIS cartography with ESRI under the STATCAP-KM programme, building the mapping base for census enumeration.

Where earth observation data is actually in use, it is in health. Climate data reaches the health information system under a formal data-exchange memorandum between the health ministry and ANACM, the national meteorological agency, and a malaria early-warning pilot in Ngazidja integrates ERA-5 climate reanalysis with routine case data (July 2026). Outside government, a seismologist at the national research and documentation centre presented two locally built models combining satellite imagery with AI agents in Moroni in August 2026, one of them watching for changes in Karthala's seismovolcanic behaviour.

Geopolitics

US / hyperscaler activities

The most consequential American technology arrival in Comoros was stopped at the border: the telecoms regulator ANRTIC banned the installation, testing, deployment and use of Starlink on 12 June 2025, acting on a ministerial circular signed three days earlier and announcing a field inspection to identify users already on the service. The regulator framed the ban as provisional rather than final, pending the grant of a licence, and required the operator to come into conformity with Comorian law through the same official procedures as any other operator — a licensing question rather than a policy objection to satellite broadband as such.

China activities

The government's newest emblem of digital sovereignty has a Chinese vendor as partner: the Technopôle numérique entered its pilot phase at a launch ceremony on 29 January 2026, presented by ministers as a decisive step towards Comorian digital sovereignty, with young people trained through a partnership with Huawei.

That is the pattern rather than the exception. China Eximbank signed a CNY 567 million concessional loan — about USD 93 million — with Comores Télécom on 11 December 2018 for the Telecommunications Network Modernization Project, on a 30-year maturity with a five-year grace period at 1% interest, financing an USD 81 million contract with Huawei to modernise the state operator's infrastructure and extend the Huri network nationally. It remains the largest single live digital commitment recorded for the country. The Nafassi fibre-to-the-home network that loan paid for launched on 22 March 2022, extending fibre to 57 further sites and carrying household broadband, television and fixed telephony over submarine capacity.

The submarine capacity is itself Chinese-built. Huawei Marine delivered the 260km Avassa cable in November 2016, linking Grande Comore, Anjouan and Mayotte for Comores Télécom and Mayotte's STOI, and giving Comoros a second international link after EASSy. On the mobile side, Yas Comores launched 5G in Moroni on 20 May 2025 using Huawei equipment, so the newest generation of radio access sits on the same vendor relationship as the fixed network beneath it.

Nothing on the financing side comes close: the Chinese loan is several times larger than the next largest commitment to the digital estate, and the remainder of the country-level money is a handful of single commitments from multilateral lenders (2026).

EU activities

European money is going into the plumbing of the Comorian state rather than into its networks. An EU-funded e-Administration programme delivered with Expertise France was officially launched in October 2025 to build a single-window service portal and an interoperability layer for the public administration — the two pieces on which any later joining-up of government services depends.

It does not stand alone, and that is the difficulty. The African Development Bank's PADEC also funds an interoperability and data-exchange platform, so the interoperability layer being built under one is being built alongside a second programme with overlapping ambitions.

Two narrower French-financed strands run beside it. The legal framework for the tax administration's téléprocédures went to a validation workshop that opened on 15 April 2026, funded through the PAGF-SI project with support from the Agence Française de Développement. And the AMECC civil registration modernisation programme, supported by France and UNICEF, launched preparatory digitisation studies in Moroni and Mohéli in October 2025 and had them validated in March 2026, with the reform still at the planning and consultation stage rather than in deployment.

Gulf/UAE activities

Gulf money in Comoros has gone to the power supply before the network. The UAE government funded a 16MW solar plant with battery storage on Grande Comore, built by Global South Utilities, a Masdar subsidiary, operating as a microgrid (April 2026) — in a country where generation, not fibre, is the constraint on anything that has to stay switched on.

On the digital estate itself, the Islamic Development Bank is financing the Project for the Digitalization of the Comorian Economy, PADEC, with about USD 7 million, active from 2025, to build a coherent range of public digital services and improve the governance, quality, affordability and accessibility of what reaches the population.

Comorian engagement with Gulf-hosted policy forums is thinner and more recent. ANADEN represented the country at the Global Assembly on the Governance of Artificial Intelligence in Riyadh in May 2024, which is where the national digital agency's contact with international AI governance sits.

India activities

No Indian-financed or India-delivered digital programme was under way in Comoros as at September 2026.

Digital sovereignty

Comoros validated a national data governance strategy for 2027-2031 on 25 August 2026 whose first axis is data sovereignty, the state setting out to control the production, storage, circulation, use and protection of the data its administration, citizens and economy generate; the minister presented it as a foundation for a future national AI policy. The strategy was built under the AUDA-NEPAD and German-cooperation Africa Data Governance Initiative, which aligns member states with the AU Data Policy Framework. No instrument fixing where state data is held or under whose law it is processed was in force as at September 2026.

State hosting is being built in separate pieces on separate money. The first public-administration data centre opened on 19 May 2025 under the World Bank-financed RCIP4 project; the finance ministry's AFD-financed PAGF-SI unit tendered in December 2025 for its own primary and backup data centres with network operations centres; and the Islamic Development Bank's e-government project procures the interoperability and data-exchange platform, with a national data centre financed by the African Development Bank (March 2026).

The national payment switch was awarded to the vendor PayLogic, and GenKey has taken over identity-document production. The terms on which the GenKey identity-document contract and the PayLogic payment-switch contract govern data jurisdiction, portability and exit had not been published as at September 2026.

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